AA-B-551D
January 18, 1973
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. AA-B-551C
June 17, 1966

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

BOOKENDS, STEEL

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers steel bookends, furnished with or without base pad.

1.2 Classification. The bookends shall be of the following types, as specified (see 6.1):

Type I Small (see 3.3)
Type II Large (see 3.3)

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following specifications and standards of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

TT-C-490 - Cleaning Methods and Pre-Treatment of Ferrous Surfaces for Organic Coating.
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material).
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (civil agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 595 - Colors.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from the Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Office in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO., Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement function should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal shall apply.

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National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Sheet steel. The bookends shall be of good commercial quality sheet steel. The thickness of the steel shall be not less than 0.0568 inch, except that Type I bookends may be formed from steel not less than 0.0344 inch thick if the requirements of paragraph 3.2.1.1, are complied with.

3.1.2 Base pad. The base pad of the bookend shall be a soft, resilient pad, to prevent damage to surfaces on which the bookend is placed and to prevent slippage.

3.2 Design and construction. The bookends shall come in two sizes (see 3.3).

3.2.1 Bookend. Each bookend shall be designed with a base and upright support, formed to an angle of approximately 90 degrees with each other. The base shall extend beyond both faces of the upright support a suitable distance, to give stability to the bookend. All corners shall be rounded and all edges shall be finished in such a way as to exclude any sharp or jagged corners or edges.

3.2.1.1 Type I, small. Type I bookends shall be fabricated of one piece of sheet steel, meeting the requirements of 3.1.1. If type I bookends are formed from sheet steel less than 0.0568 inch they shall be formed with reinforcing ridges or braces. Type I bookends shall be supplied with or without base pads meeting the requirements of 3.1.2, at the option of the contracting officer.

3.2.1.2 Type II, large. Type II bookends may be formed of one or two pieces of sheet steel. If two pieces of sheet steel are used in the construction, the upright piece shall be formed with flanges a minimum of 80% of the length of each upright side from the base up and the complete width of the bottom. These flanges shall be a minimum of 3/4 inch wide, and shall be formed toward the outside portion of the bookend (that portion which would not face the books). The base flange and the bottom of the side flanges shall be securely joined to the base by welding. All joints shall be securely joined together by welding. All type II bookends shall have a base pad meeting the requirements of 3.1.2.

3.2.2 Base pad. The base pad when required for type I bookends (see 3.2.1.1) and for all type II bookends shall completely cover the bottom of the bookend with a material that meets the requirements of 3.1.2.

3.3 Dimensions.

3.3.1 Type I, small. The following are the dimensions for the type I, small bookend.

The height of the upright support shall be 5-1/2 ± 1/4 inches.
The width of the upright support shall be 4-3/4 ± 1/8 inches.
The length of the inside portion of the base (that portion which extends from the side which would face the books) shall be 4-0 ± 1/2 inches.
The length of the outside portion of the base (that portion which extends from the side which would face away from the books) shall be 2-0 ± 1/2 inches.
The width of the outside portion of the base shall be approximately the same width as the upright support.
The width of the inside portion of the base shall be not less than one half the width of the upright support, excluding rounded edges.

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3.3.2 Type II, large. The following are the dimensions for the type II, large bookend.

The height of the upright support shall be 9-0 ± 1/2 inches.
The width of the upright support shall be 6-0 ± 1/2 inches.
The length of the inside portion of the base shall be 6-0 ± 1/2 inches.
The length of the outside portion of the base shall be 2-3/4 ± 1/2 inches.
The width of the outside portion of the base shall be approximately the same width as the upright support.
The width of the inside portion of the base shall be not less than one half the width of the upright support excluding rounded edges.

3.4 Color. The color of bookends shall be gray approximately conforming to number 26134 of Fed. Std. No. 595, or black approximately conforming to number 27038 of Fed. Std. No. 595, at the option of the contracting officer.

3.5 Finish.

3.5.1 Pretreatment. All metal surfaces of the bookend shall be treated for painting in accordance with any method of TT-C-490.

3.5.2 Priming. All surfaces shall be coated with a primer compatible with the finishing enamel.

3.5.3 Enameling. All primed surfaces of the desk tray shall be coated with enamel of the baking type in accordance with manufacturers commercial product, and shall be baked at a time temperature cycle recommended by the enamel manufacturer. Finished panels shall show no cracking, flaking or loss of adhesion of the enamel when tested as specified in 4.2.1.1.

3.6 Marking for identification. The bookend shall be marked with manufacturers name or readily identifiable trademark.

3.7 Workmanship. The surfaces of all bookends shall be free from burrs, slivers, and rough or sharp edges. The welding shall be free from pits, burn-throughs, flashes, scales or other foreign matter. The enamel coating shall level out to a continuous smooth dry film thickness without runs, wrinkles, grits or area of no film and separation of color. The coating shall be free from embedded foreign matter and shall show no evidence of peeling, flaking or blistering.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the examination and testing set forth in the specification where such are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.2.1 Inspection of components and materials. In accordance with 4.1, the supplier is responsible for insuring that components and materials used were manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with the specified requirements of referenced subsidiary specifications and standards or if none, in accordance with this specification.

4.2.1.1 In process testing. During the painting operations, the enamel shall be tested for adhesion and flexibility: at the beginning of each production lot and in the middle of each production lot and at the end of each production lot of bookends being produced, one 4 by 5 inch piece of steel being used in the production of that lot shall be prepared and enameled in the same manner, using the same materials and under the same conditions as production items. The panel shall be bent 180 degrees around a 1/8 inch diameter rod at room temperature. The panel shall then be examined for cracking, flaking or loss of adhesion of the enamel. Failure of any test panel shall be cause for rejection of all bookends represented by the panel.

4.2.2 End item inspection. The lot shall be all bookends of the same size offered for inspection at one time. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated bookend.

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4.2.2.1 Visual examination. The end item shall be examined for the defects in table I. The inspection level shall be level II and the acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 6.5, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

TABLE I. Classification of defects

Examine	Defects
Material	Not sheet steel. Thickness less than required for design used.
Design	Reinforcing ridges omitted, when required. Design does not conform to 3.2.
Color	Not as specified.
Finish and workmanship	Finish is not smooth, uniform, continuous film of enamel. Rust, runs, wrinkles, or rough areas in finish. Grit or foreign matter in finish. Chipping or scaling of finish. Book end has burrs, sharp or rough edges, or projections.

4.2.2.2 Dimensional examination. Examination shall be made of the bookend for compliance with dimensions specified. Any deviation therefrom shall constitute a defect. The inspection level shall be S3 and the AQL shall be 4.0, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units.

4.2.3 Inspection of preparation for delivery requirements. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing, and marking comply with the requirements of section 5. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging, the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to closing operations. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE II. Examination of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Material	Components missing, damaged, or otherwise defective.
Closure and workmanship	Closure of package or shipping container not as specified. Loose or missing strapping or tape, as applicable. Incomplete waterproofing of shipping container, as applicable. Damaged package or shipping container. Bulging or distortion of package or shipping container.
Content (quantity)	Number of bookends per package or shipping container not as specified. New weight exceeds weight limitation of box specification.
Marking	Omitted, incomplete, incorrect, illegible; or improper size, location or sequence.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), 12 pairs of bookends of like description shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676.

5.1.2 Level C. The bookends shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice, providing that this will insure protection for the bookends during shipment and provide for safe delivery to its destination.

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5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Unit packages of bookends of like description, packed as specified in 5.1, in quantities as specified (see 6.1), shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-663, W5c. The box shall be closed, water-proof sealed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Six unit packages of bookends of like description shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Bookends packaged as specified in 5.1.2 shall be packed in containers that will assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with the National Motor Freight Classification rules or the Uniform Freight Classification rules, as applicable.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Item and size of item required (see 1.2).
(c) Color required (see 3.4).
(d) If base pads are required (see 3.2.1.1).
(e) Level of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) Whether civil or military marking of packaging is required (see 5.3).

MILITARY INTEREST:

DOD has waived coordination on revision and amendments to this Federal Specification until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA

User Activity:

Army-GL

Orders for this publication are to be placed with the General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

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